Trimester courses and live classes: what is not working

11 November 2026. For the backend developer. Checked against https://gloxard-backend.onrender.com with read-only requests, and against the local copy of the backend.

1. Summary

- The web app was built against one set of LMS paths. The live server serves a different set, and some of the app's paths do not exist there at all. Result: the Trimester pages, scholarships, weekly path, coding labs and most live-class controls get no data on the live site.
- Trimester and scholarships exist in the local backend but are not on the live server (404).
- Live classes are partly there: the session list, join, attendance roster and polls exist. Start, end, raise hand, who is in the room, voting, closing a poll, stream and shared code do not.
- Course creation is for tutors only. The server already refuses students. Two gaps are listed in section 4: the server does not check tutor approval, and the student screen used to open the form (now fixed in the app).

2. Trimester courses

How to read the tables: the app calls the path in the second column. 404 means the live server has no such route. 401 means the route exists and needs a login.

Feature	Path the app calls	Live server	What is needed
Public Trimester list and programme page	GET /api/lms/public/trimesters, and /:id	404	Deploy, or add. The landing page shows nothing without it.
Enrol in a Trimester	POST /api/lms/trimesters/:id/enrol	404	Deploy, or add. Enrol now cannot work.
Scholarships: list and apply	GET /api/lms/public/scholarships, POST /api/lms/scholarships/:id/apply	404	Deploy, or add. The scholarships page and the home banner stay empty.
Weekly path (curriculum)	GET /api/lms/curriculum and /curriculum/weeks/:n	404	The live server has GET /api/lms/cohorts/:cohortId/curriculum instead (401, exists) with a different shape: modules, lessons, quiz and assignment. Agree one path and one response.
22-node trail (weeks 1-12)	Not built in the app	Not documented	The docs still show the old weekly shape. Send an example response, with nodeIndex, phase and completion state, and the screen can be built.
Student dashboard	Uses GET /api/lms/me, then the curriculum	/me exists (401). /api/lms/dashboard is 404	Confirm which dashboard route is meant. The docs describe a cohort-based one.
Coding labs	GET /api/lms/code-labs, and /:slug and submissions	404	Deploy, or add.
Ask a question / inquiries	GET and POST /api/lms/inquiries	404	Deploy, or add.

Feature	Path the app calls	Live server	What is needed
Gradebook	Not built in the app	404	Phase 2 in your summary. Needs weights, raw and weighted marks, and the 70% certificate rule.
Final project	Not built in the app	Exists (401) but undocumented	Document the eight stages and their responses.
Paid Trimester	Enrol on a paid Trimester	Not available	Refuses for now. Needs checkout and a webhook for cohort seats.

3. Live classes

These were probed with no login and an all-zero id. Where chat and polls answer 401 but their neighbours answer 404, the 404 most likely means the route is missing. Please confirm with a real session.

Feature	Path the app calls	Live server	What is needed
List sessions	GET /api/lms/live-sessions	401 (exists)	Works.
Join and get a LiveKit token	POST /api/lms/live-sessions/:id/join	401 (exists)	Needs a real test: confirm the LiveKit URL and keys are set on Render and the token opens a room.
Session detail	GET /api/lms/live-sessions/:id	404	Add or confirm. The class room screen opens from it.
Start and end a class	POST .../start and .../end	404	Add. A tutor cannot open or close a class.
People in the room	GET .../people	404	Add.
Raise hand	POST .../hand	404	Add.
Chat	GET and POST .../chat	GET 401, POST 404	Add the POST, or confirm the path for sending a message.
Polls	POST .../polls (401); vote and close	Create exists. Vote and close are 404	Add vote and close.
Stream and shared code	PUT .../stream and .../shared-code	404	Add.
Attendance	GET .../attendance	401 (exists)	Today it is a roster with a manual override. The spec wants it filled automatically from join and leave events, separate from replay.
Recording and replay	GET .../recording	404	Only a manually pasted recordingUrl exists. The spec wants automatic recording with states (processing, available, failed) and replay access.
YouTube Live as the second option	Not built	Not documented	Spec Q6. Missing.

4. Creating a course: tutors only

Item	State
Server refuses students	Works. Tested locally with a student account: POST, PUT and GET on /api/tutor/courses all return 403. Admins are also refused.
Server checks tutor approval	**Missing.** The tutor routes check the role only. A tutor whose status is pending or rejected can create and submit courses by calling the API directly. Only the screen blocks them. Needed: return 403 unless approvalStatus is approved.
Student sees the course form	**Fixed in the app.** A student who opened /dashboard/upload used to see the whole form and fail on save. They now see a message that the area is for tutors. The same applies to My Courses, Earnings, Reviews and Verification. Tutors are unaffected (checked with an approved tutor).
Course type on the form	The form offers regular, free and trimester to any tutor. Decide whether tutors may create trimester courses or only admins.

5. What would unblock this

- Deploy the current backend to Render and run npm run catalog:import. That alone brings back the Trimester list, programme page, enrol, scholarships, coding labs and inquiries, all of which exist locally and pass tests (LMS 117, module gating 27, practice 32).
- Settle the weekly path: either the live path (cohorts/:cohortId/curriculum) or the app's path (/curriculum). Send the final response format. The app can then be changed to match the live server.
- Add the missing live-class routes in section 3, then test one real class end to end with a tutor and a student.
- Add the approval check to the tutor course routes.